

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

DIRECTIONS: Analyze the three primary source excerpts below. Then write a response that constructs a historical argument answering the following question:

US.76 — Examine the roles and actions of civil rights advocates (e.g., Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., Malcolm X, John Lewis, Diane Nash, Thurgood Marshall, Rosa Parks) and opponents (e.g., Bull Connor, Orval Faubus, George Wallace, Strom Thurmond). (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

US.79 — Analyze how the American Indian Movement, Chicano Movement, and Feminist Movement are related to the Civil Rights Movement in advancing equality across the broader spectrum of American society during this time period.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Directions. Analyze the three primary source excerpts below. Then write a response that constructs a historical argument answering the following question: How did the convergence of the anti-war movement, the Kent State killings, and the Watergate crisis between 1969 and 1974 together erode public trust in the federal government, and what evidence suggests these events marked a fundamental shift in American political culture rather than a temporary crisis? Your response must: - Analyze at least TWO of the three documents using the SOAPS framework (Speaker, Occasion, Audience, Purpose, Significance) - Synthesize evidence across documents to support a historical argument - Connect to your own knowledge of events and long-term consequences beyond the documents - Address standards US.79 and US.82

The sources

Document 1

'Report of the President's Commission on Campus Unrest' (Scranton Commission), Chapter 3: 'The Events at Kent State,' September 26, 1970. U.S. Government Printing Office. Washington, D.C. (Public domain U.S. government document.)

“The May 4 shootings at Kent State University are an event that divided Americans deeply. The Commission believes it necessary to speak plainly: the indiscriminate firing of rifles into a crowd of students and the deaths that followed were unnecessary, unwarranted, and inexcusable. The guardsmen on Blanket Hill, fearful and anxious, may have believed they were in danger, but they were not. The deaths of four students and the wounding of nine others must be condemned.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

Vietnam Veterans Against the War (VVAW), 'Statement of John Kerry,' testimony before the Senate Foreign Relations Committee, April 22, 1971. U.S. Senate Congressional Record, 92nd Congress, 1st Session. National Archives.

“We are here in Washington to say that the problem of this war is not just a question of war and diplomacy. It is part and parcel of everything that we are trying as human beings to communicate to people in this country — the question of racism, the question of a limited nuclear capability, the question of the use of this country as a tool to maintain a façade of democracy while actually it is run by a little group of men who make most of the decisions... We are also here to ask, and we are here to ask vehemently, where are the leaders of our country? Where is the leadership?”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 3

President Richard Nixon, 'Address to the Nation Announcing His Resignation,' August 8, 1974. Public Papers of the Presidents of the United States. National Archives and Records Administration.

“I have never been a quitter. To leave office before my term is completed is abhorrent to every instinct in my body. But as President, I must put the interests of America first... I have always tried to do what was best for the Nation. Throughout the long and difficult period of Watergate, I have felt it was my duty to persevere, to make every possible effort to complete the term of office to which you elected me. In the past few days, however, it has become evident to me that I no longer have a strong enough political base in the Congress to continue that effort... Therefore, I shall resign the Presidency effective at noon tomorrow.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Use SOAPS to analyze the documents, then construct your argument in 2-3 paragraphs.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.